

DAILY NEED TO KNOW

Thursday, 23 July 2026 · Pre-market brief for Anne Wong

Covering the Wednesday 22 July 2026 US session + overnight. All times GMT+8 (HKT).

Edition: FULL — Hedgeye logged-in edition (live risk ranges & Quads).

1 Market snapshot (Wed 22 Jul close)

Asset	Last	Change	Note
S&P 500	7,498.96	▼ - 10.24 / -0.14%	Choppy fade into the Big-Tech prints
Nasdaq Composite	25,690.90	▼ - 146.30 / -0.6%	Chip-squeeze momentum faded
Dow Jones	52,218.58	► - 6.06 / <-0.1%	Flat; AT&T beat cushioned
Russell 2000	2,959.94	▼ - 27.46 / -0.9%	Small-caps lagged on higher yields
US 2Y yield	~4.20%	◆ + a few bp	Bullish; testing recent highs
US 10Y yield	~4.66%	▲ + ~3 bp	Near cycle high (4.67%) on oil
Gold (spot)	\$4,137	▲ +1.5%	Haven + reflation bid; hit \$4,167
Silver (spot)	\$59.72	▲ +1.8%	Broke out; held \$59
WTI crude	\$86.83	▲ +~3%	Longest run since spring
Brent crude	\$94.07	▲ +~2%	Highest close since 8 Jun
Bitcoin	~\$65,900	► ≈ flat	Consolidating a 5-wk high
US Dollar (DXY)	~101.0	◆ ≈ firm	Bullish TREND
VIX	17.58	▲ +3.1%	Ticked up, still complacent

Colour key: ▲ up ▼ down ◆ neutral/mixed ► little changed. A rise in yields or VIX is not necessarily good.

TL;DR: A choppy US session closed slightly lower (S&P -0.1%, Nasdaq -0.6%) as the chip squeeze faded and oil ripped — Brent settled \$94.07, its highest since 8 Jun; WTI ~\$87 — lifting the 10Y to ~4.66%, near the cycle high. After the bell, Alphabet (~-5% AH) and Tesla (-3% AH) disappointed on AI capex and free cash flow. Yet Asia rallied: Google's \$195-205bn capex guide reads as bullish for HBM/memory, so Kospi +2.8% with SK Hynix & Samsung +3%. Hedgeye's Machine confirms Global #Quad3 reflation — Oil Up, Bonds Down.

Today's actionable levels — what to watch

- ◆ S&P 500: inside Hedgeye 7,424-7,576. Support 7,424; resistance 7,576. A break of 7,424 opens the downside as the squeeze unwinds.
- ▲ US 10Y: ~4.66%, range 4.52-4.65% (bullish). The cycle high 4.67% is the line — a push through it pressures long-duration tech and gold.
- ▲ WTI: ~\$87 vs Hedgeye \$79.07-\$90.26. Watch \$90.26 (Hormuz escalation → inflation bid) vs ~\$82 TREND support on any de-escalation.
- ▼ VIX: 17.58, range 15.04-19.33 (bearish TREND). 19.33 flips the regime; sub-18 is still complacent into Intel + ECB.
- ◆ Gold: \$4,137 vs \$3,960-\$4,166 (bearish TREND). \$4,166 is the ceiling it tested; holding >\$4,140 keeps the recovery intact, a loss of \$4,080 re-opens \$4,050.

2 The big picture — what it means

- Big Tech's AI-capex bill is the new worry.** Alphabet's Q2 revenue (\$119.8bn) beat, Cloud jumped +82% to \$24.8bn and Search +17% — but it lifted 2026 capex to \$195-205bn and posted its first negative free-cash-flow quarter (~\$5.8bn on \$44bn of capex); the stock fell ~5% after hours. Tesla missed (adj EPS 33c vs ~51c) on a revenue beat (\$28.2bn) with FCF -\$1.1bn; -3% AH. Read: the market is now interrogating whether AI spend converts to cash — dispersion between the capex payers and the beneficiaries is the trade.
- Oil up, bonds down = #Quad3.** WTI reflatd ~+4% toward \$88 and Brent settled \$94.07 (highest since 8 Jun) as 2-, 10- and 30-year yields all rose. Hedgeye reads this as confirmation of reflation — inflation re-accelerating while growth decelerates. The 10Y is nearing its cycle high of 4.67%; the 30Y is grinding toward 5.18%. This is the inflation risk that keeps the Fed higher-for-longer into the 28-29 Jul FOMC.
- The AI-infrastructure trade rotates to memory.** Google's bigger capex is bearish its own stock but bullish the pick-and-shovel names: SK Hynix and Samsung (+3%) led Kospi +2.8% on the HBM/DDR5 read-through. Super Micro ripped ~+20% on \$60bn+ of new orders — including an AI data centre with SpaceX — underscoring that the physical build-out is still accelerating even as investors debate the payback.
- Positioning is calm into Intel + the ECB.** A 17.6 VIX (bearish TREND, inside 15.04-19.33) is complacent with two mega-cap prints already wobbling after hours and a live oil/Hormuz tail. Intel reports tonight (implied ~15% move, +163% YTD); the ECB is ~95% priced to hold at 2.25%. Asymmetry favours owning some optionality over chasing.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- Rates:** 2Y testing recent highs (~4.20%, bullish TRADE/TREND, Alpha Code 4.02/4.16); 10Y ~4.66% nearing the 4.67% cycle high; 30Y toward 5.18%. The process is out of Treasuries (TLT) and IG credit (LQD 106.4-107.7, bearish). No credit stress — HYG 79.51-79.89, bullish.
- US Dollar:** DXY ~101.0, firm and bullish TREND (100.44-101.50) — a reflation-plus-haven bid.
- Oil:** WTI ~\$86.83 (range \$79.07-\$90.26, bullish, Alpha Code 7882), Brent \$94.07 — highest close since 8 Jun. The Strait of Hormuz is open but highly stressed under military/diplomatic pressure; a shipping-disruption headline is the spike catalyst.
- Broad reflation:** Copper bullish (6.22-6.55); natural gas bearish (2.79-3.03). The commodity tape corroborates #Quad3.
- Precious metals:** Gold \$4,137 (+1.5%, tested \$4,167) and silver \$59.72 (+1.8%) caught a haven/reflation bid — both still sit on a bearish Hedgeye TREND (gold \$3,960-\$4,166; silver \$55-\$61).

4 Hedgeye Risk Ranges & regime

Regime: Global **#Quad3 (reflation)** — inflation re-accelerating while growth decelerates. Today's Early Look, *Oil Up, Bonds Down* = **#Quad3** (McCullough): oil's breakout above TRADE (\$78) and TREND (\$82) plus rising 2/10/30yr yields confirm reflation. The Signalling Process has exited TLT, LQD, Housing (XHB), Extended-Market (VXF) and Airlines (JETS), and is adding to Long Software (BUG) on the pullback. Immediate-term ranges (TREND = intermediate signal):

Instrument	Immediate-term risk range	TREND
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,424 – 7,576	Bullish
Nasdaq Composite	25,302 – 26,303	Bullish
Russell 2000	2,942 – 3,015	Bullish
US 10Y yield	4.52 – 4.65%	Bullish
US Dollar (DXY)	100.44 – 101.50	Bullish
WTI crude	\$79.07 – \$90.26	Bullish
Gold	\$3,960 – \$4,166	Bearish
Silver	\$55 – \$61	Bearish
Copper	\$6.22 – \$6.55	Bullish
VIX	15.04 – 19.33	Bearish
HY credit (HYG)	79.51 – 79.89	Bullish
IG credit (LQD)	106.4 – 107.7	Bearish
Tech (XLK)	\$173 – \$188	Bullish
Health Care (XLV)	\$157 – \$164	Bullish

Where price sits in its 52-week range

S&P 500 L 5,921  H 7,621 · last 7,499 (93%)
Nasdaq L 18,900  H 27,190 · last 25,691 (82%)
Dow L 41,600  H 52,700 · last 52,219 (96%)
WTI L \$58  H \$92 · last \$86.8 (85%)
Gold L \$2,780  H \$4,167 · last \$4,137 (98%)

Where we sit: S&P upper-third (bullish TREND); Nasdaq mid-upper; 10Y near the cycle high (yields higher); gold near highs but bearish TREND; VIX mid-range, bearish.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

Name	Last	Day	Cap	Read
Nvidia (NVDA)	~\$210*	▲ firmer	~\$5.1T	AI bellwether near records; HBM demand the tell
Apple (AAPL)	\$333*	◆ steady	~\$4.9T	YTD leader; relative haven on a red tape
Microsoft (MSFT)	\$401*	◆ steady	~\$3.0T	GOOGL capex read-through; reports next wk
Alphabet (GOOGL)	\$356*	▼ ~5% AH	~\$4.3T	Rev beat but capex guide + neg FCF hit it
Amazon (AMZN)	\$250*	◆ mixed	~\$2.7T	Range-bound; AWS the key line, reports next wk
Meta (META)	\$665*	▼ softer	~\$1.7T	AI-capex scrutiny into next-wk print
Tesla (TSLA)	\$391*	▼ -3% AH	~\$1.5T	EPS miss; Hedgeye tagged it Do NOT Buy

* Last confirmed cash close 22 Jul (or prior); GOOGL & TSLA moves are the after-hours earnings reaction. Confirm live before acting.

6 Positioning & options

- **VIX:** 17.58 (+3.1%) — ticked up but calm; range 15.04–19.33, bearish TREND. ~19.33 is the level that flips the regime.
- **Two-sided into the open:** Bitcoin steady ~\$65.9k and a silver breakout point to residual risk-appetite, but GOOGL/TSLA after-hours weakness risks a Nasdaq-100 gap-down at the cash open.
- **Net read:** reflation priced with credit calm (HYG bullish) — not a scare, but a tape re-pricing capex discipline. Watch VIX reclaiming 19.33 or HYG cracking 79.51. (Live add: CBOE put/call, CNN Fear & Greed.)

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

- **Leaders:** Energy/oil, precious metals & materials (gold \$4,137, silver +1.8%), memory/HBM (SK Hynix, Samsung, Micron), select data-centre (Super Micro +~20%), and Canadian energy/materials (TSX +0.33%).
- **Laggards:** Mega-cap internet into/after prints (GOOGL, TSLA after hours), small-caps (Russell -0.9% on yields), long-duration bonds (TLT) and IG credit (LQD).
- **Rotation read:** leadership is rotating toward reflation (oil, copper, metals) and the AI pick-and-shovel, and away from richly-valued capex payers — classic #Quad3 behaviour.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

- **Futures (as Asia trades):** US futures slipped, led lower by Nasdaq-100 as Alphabet fell ~5% after hours — the tape is digesting the capex message.

Day	Key events
Wed 22	Reported: Alphabet, Tesla, IBM (cut FY sales view), ServiceNow, Texas Instruments, AT&T (+4%), Super Micro (+~20%).
Thu 23	★ ECB decision (hold 2.25% expected) + Lagarde presser; US jobless claims; ★ Intel (AMC, ~15% implied); Honeywell, T-Mobile, Thermo Fisher (BMO).
Fri 24	★ S&P Global flash PMIs (Jul); New Home Sales (Jun); American Express, Charter, HCA (BMO).
Next	FOMC 28–29 Jul · BoJ 30 Jul · China Politburo (stimulus signal) late July.

9 Corporate news

- **Alphabet:** rev \$119.8bn beat; Cloud +82% to \$24.8bn; Search +17%; but 2026 capex raised to \$195–205bn and first negative-FCF quarter (–\$5.8bn); ~5% AH.
- **Tesla:** adj EPS 33c missed; rev \$28.2bn beat; FCF –\$1.1bn; –3% AH. Hedgeye tagged it Do NOT Buy into the print.
- **IBM:** lowered its annual sales outlook — a software/consulting caution flag.
- **Super Micro +~20%:** \$60bn+ of new orders, including an AI data centre with SpaceX.
- **AT&T +4%:** EPS and subscriber beat; revenue +2.3% to \$31.6bn.
- **Tonight:** Intel reports after the close — the read on the foundry/AI-PC recovery (+163% YTD, ~15% implied move).

10 Macro data

- **US:** no major releases Wednesday; ~88% of S&P 500 reporters beating EPS. Softer June CPI/PPI vs firm retail sales, low jobless claims and a Philly-Fed rebound leave rate expectations two-sided into the 28–29 Jul FOMC.
- **Europe:** ECB decides today (13:45 CET; ~95% priced to hold at 2.25%) with a Lagarde presser; a softer UK inflation print helped the FTSE +1.24%. Hormuz/oil complicate the inflation path.
- **China:** LPRs at record lows; the late-July Politburo is the stimulus catalyst.
- **Japan:** BoJ policy 30 Jul; the yen and rate path remain the Nikkei's swing factor.

11 Geopolitics

- **Iran / Strait of Hormuz:** open but highly stressed transit under active military and diplomatic pressure. US officials warned Asian leaders that Iran's push to charge tolls through the strait threatens global commerce; Brent \$94 reflects the premium. Any tanker/shipping-disruption headline is the spike catalyst.
- **Houthi / Red Sea:** renewed threats to Red Sea and Gulf flows add a fresh leg to the energy risk premium.

12 Asia setup — today (Thu 23 Jul)

Index	Level / move	Read
Kospi (Korea)	▲ +2.8%	Samsung & SK Hynix +3%; AI-memory leads
Nikkei 225	▲ firmer	Chip/AI follow-through
Topix	▲ firmer	Broad-based bid
Hang Seng	▼ –0.95% (~24,893)	Lags; China internet mixed
CSI 300	◆ ≈ steady	Awaiting late-Jul Politburo
S&P/ASX 200	◆ +0.34% (~8,823)	Energy & materials firm

Read: Korea and the memory names lead on the read-through that Big Tech's bigger AI capex means more HBM/infrastructure spend — SK Hynix & Samsung +3% inside Kospi +2.8%; Hong Kong lags. The key tell is whether the GOOGL/TSLA after-hours selloff drags US futures at the cash open, and whether the next Hormuz headline moves oil and gold.

13 AI watch

- **Capex at scale:** Alphabet's \$195–205bn 2026 capex (and first negative-FCF quarter) is the marquee signal — the market is now pricing whether hyperscaler AI spend converts to cash. Read-through to Microsoft, Meta and Amazon prints next week.
- **Memory supercycle:** bigger hyperscaler capex is bullish HBM — SK Hynix, Samsung and Micron are the pick-and-shovel. Super Micro's \$60bn+ backlog (incl. a SpaceX AI data centre) corroborates the physical build-out.
- **Intel tonight:** a ~15% implied move and +163% YTD make it the session's AI swing factor — the read on foundry and AI-PC demand.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Space × AI:** the Super Micro / SpaceX AI-data-centre tie-up is a notable widening of the AI build-out beyond the usual hyperscalers.
- **Weather (market-moving):** a European heatwave continues to stress the EU corn/maize belt — watch grains, softs and European power.
- **Water cooler:** Tour de France final week; MLB in full swing; a strong summer box office remains a tailwind for exhibitors.

15 Appendix — stock cards

Every name mentioned above plus the top global names — last + day · market cap · valuation · next key date · one-line read. Prices are 22 Jul cash close unless flagged * (prior close / delayed / after-hours). No charts.

US — movers & mega-caps

Nvidia (NVDA) ~\$210* ▲ firmer Cap ~\$5.1T Val P/E ~32 Next: <i>Reports late Aug</i> AI bellwether near record highs; HBM the tell.	Alphabet (GOOGL) \$356* ▼ ~5% AH Cap ~\$4.3T Val P/E ~24 Next: <i>Reported 22 Jul</i> Rev/Cloud beat; 2026 capex \$195–205bn + first neg-FCF qtr spooked it.
Apple (AAPL) \$333* ◆ steady Cap ~\$4.9T Val P/E ~33 Next: <i>Reports late Jul/Aug</i> Group YTD leader; relative haven.	Microsoft (MSFT) \$401* ◆ steady Cap ~\$3.0T Val P/E ~36 Next: <i>Reports next wk</i> Azure/AI capex in focus after GOOGL.
Amazon (AMZN) \$250* ◆ mixed Cap ~\$2.7T Val P/E ~38 Next: <i>Reports next wk</i> Range-bound; AWS growth the key line.	Meta (META) \$665* ▼ softer Cap ~\$1.7T Val P/E ~27 Next: <i>Reports next wk</i> Consolidating; AI-capex scrutiny.
Tesla (TSLA) \$391* ▼ –3% AH Cap ~\$1.5T Val rich Next: <i>Reported 22 Jul</i> Adj EPS 33c miss; rev \$28.2bn beat; FCF –\$1.1bn.	Intel (INTC) confirm live* ◆ into print Cap ~\$0.2T Val turnaround Next: <i>Earnings tonight (Thu 23, AMC)</i> +163% YTD; ~15% implied move; foundry/AI-PC read.
Super Micro (SMCI) \$30.56 ▲ +~20% Cap ~\$0.02T Val cyclical Next: <i>Reported 22 Jul</i> \$60bn+ new orders incl. a SpaceX AI data centre.	AT&T (T) firm* ▲ +4% Cap ~\$0.16T Val P/E ~13 Next: <i>Reported 22 Jul</i> EPS + subs beat; rev +2.3% to \$31.6bn.
IBM (IBM) n/a* ▼ guide cut Cap ~\$0.25T Val P/E ~24 Next: <i>Reported 22 Jul</i> Lowered annual sales outlook; software watch.	Micron (MU) firm* ▲ memory bid Cap ~\$0.2T Val cyclical Next: <i>Reports late Sep</i> HBM/DDR5 leader; core of the memory supercycle.

Europe — top 5

ASML (ASML) \$1,740* ◆ — Cap ~\$670B Val P/E ~55 Next: <i>Reported ~21 Jul</i> AI-litho monopoly; capex read-through to memory.	SAP (SAP) \$158* ◆ — Cap ~\$185B Val P/E ~22 Next: <i>Reported ~21 Jul</i> EU software bellwether; cloud backlog the watch.
Novo Nordisk (NVO) \$49* ◆ — Cap ~\$218B Val P/E ~12 Next: <i>Reports early Aug</i> Cheap; GLP-1 competition the overhang.	Shell (SHEL) firm* ▲ w/ oil Cap ~\$220B Val P/E ~11 Next: <i>Reports end-Jul</i> Energy beneficiary of the Hormuz premium.
LVMH (MC.PA) n/a ◆ — Cap ~\$350B Val P/E ~22 Next: <i>Reported recently</i> Luxury bellwether; China demand the swing.	

Asia ex-China — top 6 (live / most-recent)

TSMC (2330 / TSM) \$405* ▲ +1% Cap ~\$1.9T Val P/E ~27 Next: <i>Reported 16 Jul</i> Record Q2; region anchor; 2027 price-hike story.	SK Hynix (000660) firm* ▲ +~3% Cap mega-cap Val cyclical Next: <i>Reports late Jul</i> HBM4 leader; Kospi engine on the capex read.
Samsung Elec (005930) firm* ▲ +~3% Cap mega-cap Val P/E ~14 Next: <i>Reports late Jul</i> AI-memory leverage; core of the Kospi bid.	Sony (6758) n/a ◆ — Cap ~¥20T Val P/E ~20 Next: <i>Reports Aug</i> Games/imaging; steady.
SoftBank (9984) firm* ▲ +0.3% Cap large-cap Val NAV Next: <i>Reports Aug</i> AI/portfolio proxy (Arm, OpenAI exposure).	Kioxia (285A) firm* ▲ — Cap large-cap Val cyclical Next: <i>Reports Aug</i> NAND maker; rides the memory complex.

China — top 6 (live / most-recent)

Alibaba (9988 / BABA) \$120* ▲ ADR firm Cap ~\$274B Val P/E ~18 Next: <i>Reports mid-Aug</i>	Baidu (9888 / BIDU) n/a* ▲ +~12% Cap ~\$40B Val P/E ~11 Next: <i>Reports Aug</i>
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AI re-rating on Qwen; strongest China story.	AI/robotaxi optimism drove a pop.
Xiaomi (1810) HK\$26*  Cap ~HK\$664B Val P/E ~30 <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> Strong EV deliveries; off highs.	Kweichow Moutai (600519) firm*  Cap ~¥1.6T Val P/E ~20 <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> Consumer-luxury proxy; off highs.
BYD (1211) n/a  Cap ~HK\$900B Val P/E ~18 <i>Next: Reports late Aug</i> EV leader; delivery momentum the driver.	Meituan (3690) n/a  Cap ~HK\$800B Val P/E ~20 <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> Local services; margin recovery watch.

Sources: Index closes & narrative: Kitco PM Report, Yahoo Finance, CNBC, The Motley Fool, TheStreet, Bloomberg (22 Jul). Earnings: CNBC, FXStreet, Traders Union, TradingKey (GOOGL, TSLA, IBM, SMCI, AT&T). Rates/commodities/FX/crypto: Kitco, Trading Economics, Investing.com. Asia & macro: CNBC, TradingKey, Finance Calendar (ECB), Bloomberg. Risk ranges, Alpha Codes & Quads: Hedgeye Early Look Oil Up, Bonds Down = #Quad3 (logged-in edition, 22 Jul).

Data-confidence: Wed 22 Jul US index closes confirmed & cross-checked (Kitco vs Yahoo/TheStreet); the S&P close of 7,498.96 is a 10.24-pt decline from Tuesday's 7,509.20. All top figures sit inside their Hedgeye ranges. Several mega-cap/Europe/Asia/China card prices are prior-close, delayed or after-hours (flagged *) — verify live before acting. This is the FULL Hedgeye edition (logged-in browser reachable).